



WEEK TWO · MODULE FOUR

Your Annotated Luxury Codes

The document in which you find your own errors

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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HOW TO STUDY THIS MODULE

This deliverable is unlike any other in the programme, because its subject is you.

It cannot be researched. It can only be observed, and it will make you slightly uncomfortable. That discomfort is the deliverable.

Submit before your mentorship session. We will spend the session on the entries you least wanted to write.

CHAPTER I

What you are producing

And why it is about you rather than about the codes

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

State the purpose of the annotated codes document.

Understand why a list of rules would be worthless here.

1.1 · What it is not

It is not a summary of the module. It is not a list of the codes. It is not a beautiful set of notes on etiquette, and if you hand me one of those I will hand it straight back, because it will prove only that you can copy.

1.2 · What it is

DEFINITION

Your Annotated Luxury Codes. A working document in which you identify, in writing, the specific ways in which you personally currently signal that you are outside this world, and what you will do instead.

The codes themselves are in Module 1 and in the Dictionary. You can look them up for the rest of your life. What you cannot look up is which of them you are breaking, right now, without knowing it. That is the only thing this week can give you, and it is the only thing worth having.

1.3 · Why this is uncomfortable, and why that is correct

Everyone who has ever done this exercise honestly has found at least one entry that stung. That entry is the most valuable line in your document, and it is very likely the one you will be tempted to soften or leave out.

THE INSTRUCTION

Do not write the version of yourself you would like me to meet.

Write the version a family will meet, on a Tuesday, when you are tired.

CHAPTER II

The specification

Four parts, and none of them optional

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Produce each of the four parts to the required standard.

Part	What it contains
1 · Ten words I have been using	Ten words or phrases you actually use, drawn from your real speech, that mark you as outside this world. For each: the word, what it announces about you, and the exact replacement. At least three must come from your recording of Drill One, not from the module.
2 · My three tells	The three physical or behavioural tells that are yours. Not a list of possible tells: yours . Perfume, sound, telephone, stillness, volume, the smile that appears when you are nervous, the hands that need something to hold. Name them precisely, and say what you will do instead.
3 · Twenty terms from the Dictionary	Twenty entries you did not know, or thought you knew and did not. For each: the term, the correction, and one line on where it would have caught you out. Ten of the twenty must be from the private-service entries rather than from gastronomy: family office, NDA, rota, household budget, black book, background check, chief of staff, security detail, estate manager, empty leg.
4 · The five sentences	The five sentences from this week, written from memory, with the situation in which each is used. Certainly. I will see to it. Leave it with me. It is arranged. I am not able to help with that, but let me pass it to the office.

CHAPTER III

Standards

What an honest entry looks like, and what a dishonest one looks like

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Distinguish an observation from a performance of humility.

The failure mode of this document is not laziness. It is **polite self-criticism**: entries that sound humble but cost nothing, and that reveal that you did not really look.

DISHONEST · WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

"I sometimes talk a bit too much when I am nervous."

"I could be more confident in formal settings."

"I use the word amazing sometimes."

Each of these is safe, vague, and unfalsifiable. None of them would change a single thing you do tomorrow morning. This is the sound of someone completing an exercise, not of someone looking.

HONEST · WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

"In my recording I said *amazing* four times in ninety seconds, and I said *to be honest* twice. I will replace both with nothing at all."

"My voice rises at the end of my sentences, which turns every statement into a question and asks for permission. I will end sentences downward, and stop."

"I fill silences. In the recording there are three places where I had finished and kept talking. I will finish, and then be quiet, and let it be uncomfortable."

"I wear a bracelet that makes a sound when I set down a plate. I have not worn it since Tuesday."

Notice what the honest entries share. Each one is **specific**, each one is **evidenced** (usually from the recording), and each one **implies an action you have already taken or will take tomorrow**. That is the standard. There is no other.

CHAPTER IV

A complete worked example

One candidate, honestly done

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Read a finished document at the required standard.

Use its shape, never its content.

This is a composite, built from the first cohort. Do not copy it. A copied document is visible in four seconds, and it will be returned.

PART 1 · TEN WORDS I HAVE BEEN USING

"Amazing." Four times in ninety seconds, in my recording. Announces that I am surprised by nice things. **Replace with:** nothing. Or "very good".

"Exclusive." Announces that I have been excluded and am still thinking about it. **Replace with:** the name of the place, once, quietly.

"No problem." Announces that there might have been one. **Replace with:** "Certainly."

"To be honest." Announces that the rest of the time I am not. **Replace with:** nothing.

"I managed to..." Announces effort, and hands it back to them. **Replace with:** "It is arranged."

"Sorry to bother you, but..." Announces that I am a bother. **Replace with:** "When you have a moment."

"Luxury." Twice, in an interview, last year. I did not get the role. **Replace with:** never say it again.

"Absolutely!" Too much energy. Eagerness is a tell. **Replace with:** "Certainly."

"I just wanted to check..." "Just" is an apology hiding in a sentence. **Replace with:** "May I confirm..."

"Does that make sense?" Asks them to reassure me. **Replace with:** stop talking.

PART 2 · MY THREE TELLS

My voice rises at the end of sentences. Every statement becomes a request for approval. I heard it in the recording and could not un-hear it. I am ending sentences downward, and stopping.

I fill silences. Three times in ninety seconds I had finished and kept going. From now on I finish, and I let the silence sit, even when it is uncomfortable, especially when it is uncomfortable.

My hands. When I am not doing something I touch my hair, my sleeve, my necklace. In a room with a principal that reads as anxiety. I am keeping my hands still, at my sides, and it is much harder than it sounds.

PART 3 · TWENTY TERMS · A SAMPLE OF FIVE

Family office. I did not know this existed. I assumed families hired directly. It would have caught me out in the first interview, when I would have asked who my manager was and heard an answer I did not understand.

Rota. I thought this was informal. It is a document, and in a serious house it is *the* document. I would have arrived expecting to be told my hours.

Empty leg. I had heard the term and never known what it meant. I would have nodded. That is the bluff, and it is the thing I have promised myself I will never do again.

Palace (France). I thought this was a compliment. It is an official rank above five stars. I have used it loosely, and to the wrong people.

Patina. I would have polished it. I would genuinely have polished it, thinking I was being helpful, and I would have destroyed something and never understood why the room went quiet.

PART 4 · THE FIVE SENTENCES

"Certainly." The answer to a request. Closes, commits, contains no emotion.

"I will see to it." When the matter is now mine and they need never think of it again.

"Leave it with me." Warmer, for small things. Removes the burden visibly.

"It is arranged." The correct and complete account of a difficult afternoon.

"I am not able to help with that, but let me pass it to the office." The refusal. No apology, no explanation, no softening, and then silence.

CHAPTER V

The marking rubric

How I will read it

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Anticipate the five criteria.

Understand the single failure that results in a rework.

Criterion	What earns the mark
Evidence	At least three of your ten words come from your own recording, quoted, with the count. Not from the module. If nothing in the document came from hearing yourself, you did not do the exercise.
Specificity	Every entry names a behaviour, not a quality. "I fill silences, three times in ninety seconds" earns the mark. "I could be more concise" does not.
Discomfort	At least one entry made you wince to write. If nothing did, you wrote the version of yourself you would like me to meet, and I will know.
Action	Every entry implies something you will do differently tomorrow, and several imply something you have already done. "I have not worn the bracelet since Tuesday" is worth more than a page of intentions.
The Dictionary	Twenty terms, ten of them from private service rather than gastronomy. This is the part people skip, and it is the part that shows in an interview.
Band	Standard
Distinction	Evidenced from the recording. At least one entry that clearly cost something to write. Actions already taken.
Pass	Honest, specific, but drawn from the module rather than from self-observation. The right instinct, insufficiently applied to yourself.
Rework	Polite self-criticism. Vague qualities instead of behaviours. A tidy summary of the codes with no trace of the person who wrote it. Returned, with the reason, and resubmitted before Week Three opens.

CHAPTER VI

Common failures, and submission

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Avoid the five errors that produce a rework.

- **Summarising the module.** I wrote the module. I know what is in it. I want to know what is in you.
- **Skipping the recording.** It is the only source of evidence you have, and it is the only part of this exercise that cannot be faked.
- **Choosing safe tells.** "I talk too much when nervous" is safe. "My voice rises at the end of every sentence and asks for permission" is true. Only one of them changes anything.
- **Doing the Dictionary from memory.** Twenty terms means opening it, reading it, and being honest about what you did not know. Nobody knows all of it. Pretending to is, ironically, the exact error the module is about.
- **Writing beautifully.** This document is not a piece of writing. It is a mirror. Bullet points, short lines, no adornment.

Submission

Two pages maximum. PDF. Submitted before your mentorship session, with your Drill One recording attached.

And in the session, we will begin with the entry you least wanted to write. That is not a threat. It is where the money is.

ÉMILIE'S NOTE

Reserved. This is where I add what I saw, in my own words.

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